

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

FLOOR SUBSTITUTE
FOR ENGROSSED

HOUSE BILL NO. 4427

By: Hilbert, Pogemiller,
Provenzano, Waldron, and
Ranson of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

FLOOR SUBSTITUTE

[adjunct teachers - distinguished qualifications -
core curriculum subjects - alternative placement
teaching certificate - effective date]

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L.
2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), is amended to read as
follows:

Section 6-122.12. A. Public school districts in this state may
employ adjunct teachers who have a minimum of a high school diploma
and are persons with distinguished qualifications in their field.
The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules providing
distinguished qualifications for adjunct teachers.

1 B. 1. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, adjunct
2 teachers shall be prohibited from teaching core curriculum subjects
3 including, but not limited to, mathematics, English language arts,
4 science, and social studies in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade.

5 2. If an adjunct teacher was employed by a public school
6 district to teach a core curriculum subject in pre-kindergarten
7 through fifth grade prior to the 2027-2028 school year, the public
8 school district may apply to the State Board of Education for a
9 waiver to continue the adjunct teacher's employment. To be eligible
10 for a waiver, the adjunct teacher shall be required to complete or
11 shall have completed professional development training in the
12 science of reading provided by the State Department of Education.

13 If the Board grants the waiver, the public school district may
14 continue to employ the adjunct teacher to teach core curriculum
15 subjects in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade, subject to the
16 limitation provided for in subsection C of this section.

17 C. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, public school
18 districts shall be prohibited from employing an adjunct teacher for
19 more than five (5) years unless the employing public school district
20 applies to the State Board of Education for a waiver. The State
21 Department of Education shall develop a waiver application, which
22 shall include a requirement to submit the adjunct teacher's
23 distinguished qualifications. The Board may grant a waiver allowing
24 the adjunct teacher to be employed for an additional five (5) years.

1 D. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this
2 section who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be
3 considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

4 E. The State Department of Education shall publish an annual
5 report on the status of adjunct teachers, authorized by Section 6-
6 122.3 of ~~Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes~~ this title, in this
7 state. The report shall include:

8 1. Qualifications adopted by the State Board of Education to
9 determine eligibility of adjunct teacher candidates;

10 2. The subject areas or courses in which adjunct teachers are
11 teaching; and

12 3. The types of distinguished qualifications adjunct teachers
13 have to make them qualified to teach in certain subject areas or
14 courses.

15 ~~B.~~ F. The annual report shall be published on the website of
16 the State Department of Education and copies of the report shall be
17 provided to ~~elected~~ members of the ~~Oklahoma~~ House of Representatives
18 and the ~~Oklahoma State~~ Senate no later than January 15 of each year.

19 SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as
20 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
21 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

22 Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant
23 an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes
24 application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has attained a retention grade point average ~~of~~ not less than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or
- b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education, professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree, or a master of library science degree, from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting agency which is recognized by the ~~Secretary of the United States Department~~ Secretary of Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal degrees, or
- c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an institution whose accreditation is recognized by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has qualified work experience in a field that corresponds to an area of certification as determined by the State Board of Education, and
- d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b, ~~and~~ or c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency or completed a major in a field that

1 corresponds to an area of specialization for an
2 Elementary-Secondary Certificate or a Secondary
3 Certificate as determined by the State Board of
4 Education or a vocational-technical certificate as
5 recommended by the Oklahoma Department of Career and
6 Technology Education;

7 2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by
8 means of an alternative placement program in not more than three (3)
9 years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject
10 matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the
11 professional education component for each person making application
12 for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the
13 criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

14 The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of
15 six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of
16 eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock
17 hours for the professional education component.

18 The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all
19 student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of
20 subsection ~~E~~ F of this section;

21 3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency
22 examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of
23 specialization for which certification is sought; and
24

1 4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school
2 district in this state offering employment in the area of
3 specialization for which certification is sought on condition that
4 the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by
5 the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek
6 employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in
7 this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection
8 shall be considered a ~~"valid~~ valid certificate of ~~qualification~~
9 qualification for the purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this
10 title, and the holder of the certificate shall be considered an
11 inductee for the purposes of Section 6-195 of this title.

12 B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be
13 renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon
14 presentation of a document from an accredited public school district
15 in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of
16 specialization and a document from a teacher education institution
17 verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative
18 placement program.

19 C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

20 1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education
21 program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education,
22 the ~~North Central Association of Colleges and Schools~~ Higher
23 Learning Commission, and by the ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for Teacher
24 ~~Preparation~~ Educational Quality and Accountability to offer teacher

1 education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed
2 courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of
3 the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

4 2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an
5 ~~Oklahoma~~ institution of higher education in this state a plan for
6 meeting standard certification requirements within three (3) years;
7 and

8 3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section
9 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as
10 other inductees.

11 D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the
12 requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an
13 individual of specific competency in the subject area of
14 specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The
15 State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant
16 exceptions.

17 E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the
18 Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an
19 exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination
20 for initial certification in a field which does not require an
21 advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an
22 advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the
23 content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be
24 from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting

1 agency which is recognized by the United States Secretary ~~of the~~
2 ~~U.S. Department~~ of Education. The Commission shall provide the
3 Board with the necessary information to determine comparability.

4 F. Student teaching and a ~~pre-student~~ pre-student teaching field
5 experience shall not be required of alternative placement program
6 participants for standard certification.

7 ~~G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules~~
8 ~~authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished~~
9 ~~qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be~~
10 ~~required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an~~
11 ~~adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a~~
12 ~~valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as~~
13 ~~defined by Section 1-116 of this title.~~

14 ~~H.~~ Each teacher education institution shall provide the
15 ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for ~~Teacher Preparation~~ Educational Quality and
16 Accountability an annual report of information as specified by the
17 Commission regarding participation in the alternative placement
18 programs offered by the institution.

19 ~~I.~~ H. The ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for ~~Teacher Preparation~~
20 Educational Quality and Accountability shall not accredit, renew the
21 accreditation of, or otherwise approve any teacher education program
22 of any institution of higher education in this state that has not
23 implemented alternative placement programs in at least four areas of
24 specialization, including mathematics, science, and a foreign

1 language. Each institution shall allow individuals who meet the
2 criteria of subsections A and C of this section to be:

3 1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further
4 qualification; and

5 2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for
6 standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section
7 during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year
8 of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any
9 person seeking standard certification through an alternative
10 placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses
11 during regular semesters if offered.

12 ~~±~~ I. The criteria specified in subsection ~~±~~ H of this section
13 ~~can~~ may be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two
14 or more institutions of higher education.

15 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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